Nickita Khylkouski

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Experience

Peak Security Jul 2026 – Present
Founder *San Francisco, CA*

- Pentest websites cheaply and at scale, then report the vulnerabilities. $0 to six-figure MRR in four months; $350K profit to date.
- Ran ∼19,000 assessments at ∼$1.50 each, ∼1.5T tokens total, at a profit. Built the system that runs hundreds at once across hundreds of VMs at ∼200M tokens per minute without losing or corrupting runs.
- Found and reported security issues involving a16z, Palantir, Thiel Fellows, Y Combinator, Broadcom, federal banks, and local governments. Findings paid up to ∼$30K and uncovered active intrusions by third parties that were referred to the FBI.
- YC Fellows ($20K grant) and Palantir Valley Forge ($10K grant).

Replit Jun 2026 – Aug 2026
Security Engineer & SWE Intern *San Francisco, CA*

- Built and led the launch of Black-box Pen Tests: attacks deployed apps from the outside, no source access, and reports only confirmed vulnerabilities.
- Shipped as a built-in scan in Replit's Security Center. Launch reached ∼150K views.

Cerebral Valley Dec 2025 – Jun 2026
Security Engineer / Software Engineer *San Francisco, CA*

- Built the applicant sorting system for Anthropic's Opus 4.7 / 4.8 events: 40,000 applicants reduced to 1,000 by pairwise LLM comparisons and Elo-style rating.
- Ran OSINT on 6K+ applicants: thousands of research agents enriched every profile for recruiting and sponsor analytics.
- Hired after responsibly disclosing vulnerabilities in the company's platform.

AI Valley Oct 2025 – Feb 2026
Tech Lead *San Francisco, CA*

- Built judging and submission software used by 5K+ hackathon users: scoring, submissions, reviewer workflows, live event ops.
- Helped host 19 AI events with OpenAI, Google, Anthropic, Netflix, AWS, Vercel, and Y Combinator: 3,700+ attendees, including one 1,200+ signup event. Spoke at TechEx North America on building AI coding agents.

Projects

Builder Evaluation Engine | *Python, pairwise LLM evaluation, Elo ratings* 2026 – Present

- Rates 30K+ builders from GitHub activity, competition history, talks, and CTF results, with anonymization and position-bias controls.
- Predicts hackathon winners from public data alone: at YC Hack the Stackathon it scraped 7,000+ participants and called the 1st and 3rd place teams before judging.

Open Source | *Python, Java, Go, TypeScript* 2024 – Present

- 20+ PRs to open source, including Google's Mug, Dotprompt, Guava, and go-github, and other repos.

Flatlander, Boids, DateGuesser | *Geometry, dynamical systems, number theory*

- Flatlander: a 3D world observed through a single 2D cross-section, the dimensional analogy for seeing 4D. Boids: emergent flocking in $\mathbb{R}^2$ and $\mathbb{R}^3$ from local separation, alignment, and cohesion rules. DateGuesser: weekday of any date via the Doomsday algorithm and modular arithmetic.

Awards & Teaching

2nd place, $10K: YC Hack the Stackathon. **Audience Favorite**: Alif × Replit World's Greatest Tournament, for finding vulnerabilities in oil ships in Venezuela and Nigeria and reporting them.
Winner: AGI House AI4Healthcare, cua.ai Computer-Use Agents Hackathon, Replicate Hackathon, Dumb Hackathon, Single Shot Hackathon, AGI House × Omi, Hack for Social Impact.
Inspirit AI: taught AI fundamentals to 60 students; reached 2,500+ learners through educational initiatives.

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, TypeScript, Go, Java, C/C++
Security / AI: Web and API pentesting, authorization testing, severity triage, OSINT, LLM agents, pairwise evaluation and Elo rating